The post-Cold War period (1990s–early 2000s) witnessed the expansion of drone applications beyond military use. The enhanced reliability and reduced cost of electronic components enabled UAVs to enter civilian sectors such as agriculture, environmental monitoring, meteorology, cartography, and aerial photography. Lightweight designs, electric propulsion, and GPS integration allowed for precise, long-duration missions suitable for scientific and commercial operations.

Table 3.1 presents the chronological development of second-generation drones, tracing their evolution from early Cold War reconnaissance systems to advanced, GPS-guided aerial platforms of the late 20th century. Each listed UAV reflects a milestone in unmanned technology, demonstrating progress in navigation, propulsion, data transmission, and automation. The table highlights how these innovations transformed drones from experimental military tools into reliable, multi-role aerial systems, laying the foundation for the autonomous and AI-integrated UAVs of the modern era.